25901476 **Reg.No: .....**
Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATIONS, MARCH 2026
FOURTH SEMESTER
DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC ELECTIVE (DSE)- MG4DSEPSY200-EXPLORING HEALTH PSYCHOLOGY
2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS

DURATION: 2 HOURS MAXIMUM MARKS: 70 MARKS

ANSWER SCHEME

PART A

1. d) Across life span
2. d) Self-efficacy
3. b) Flight response
4. b) Rural–urban disparity in access to health services
5. b) Ulcers
6. b) Preventing initiation of smoking
7. a) A direct and negative effect
8. a) Contemplation to Preparation
9. c) When patients receive clear, jargon-free explanations and are asked to repeat instructions
10. d) All of the above
11. b) Self Integrity
12. c) harm, threat or challenge
13. c) They often have no symptoms until serious damage occurs
14. c) Socialization and trauma type
15. c) They involve unhealthy patterns of eating and concerns about body image

[2*15=30 MARKS]

PART B

16. Explain the need and significance of health psychology in the modern health care system.

Ans: Changing Patterns of Illness: Shift from acute diseases (e.g., tuberculosis, influenza) to chronic diseases (e.g., heart disease, diabetes, cancer). Chronic illnesses require long-term management, lifestyle modification, and self-care**. Psychological factors** such as stress, behaviour, and coping influence disease onset and progression. Role of **Behavioural Factors**: Health behaviours (diet, exercise, smoking, alcohol use) directly affect health outcomes. Health psychology promotes behaviour change and healthy lifestyle adoption. Helps improve adherence to treatment and preventive practices. **Advances in Technology and Research**: Medical advancements (e.g., genetic testing, modern treatments) require patient understanding and adaptation. Health psychology helps individuals cope with

psychological stress related to diagnosis and treatment decisions. **Expansion of Health Care Services**: Healthcare has expanded to include prevention, rehabilitation, and health promotion. Health psychologists contribute to improving patient care, satisfaction, and accessibility**. Focus on Prevention and Cost Reduction**: Emphasis on preventive healthcare reduces long-term treatment costs. Encourages early adoption of healthy behaviours to avoid chronic diseases. **Increased Medical Acceptance:** Growing recognition of the biopsychosocial model in healthcare. Psychological interventions (e.g., stress management, CBT) improve treatment outcomes and recovery. **Psychological and Social Adjustment**: Chronic illness leads to emotional stress, anxiety, and lifestyle changes. Health psychology supports coping, family adjustment, and social support systems. Added points: Bio-psychosocial model

17. **Define binge-watching. Discuss the psychological and social factors influencing binge-watching behaviour**

Ans: Binge-watching refers to the **continuous watching of multiple episodes of a TV series or digital content in a single sitting**, often for extended hours.

Psychological Factors: Escapism: Used to avoid stress, anxiety, or real-life problems. **Reward & Pleasure:** Immediate gratification and dopamine-driven enjoyment. **Emotional Engagement:** Attachment to characters and storyline. **Habit Formation/Addiction:** Loss of self-control and compulsive viewing. **Loneliness & Mood Regulation:** Used to manage boredom or negative emotions.

Social Factors: Peer Influence: Popular shows create social pressure to watch. **Cultural Trends:** Streaming culture promotes “watch-all-at-once” behaviour. **Social Connectivity:** Watching to participate in discussions (friends/social media). **Accessibility:** Easy availability via OTT platforms (Netflix, etc.). **Reduced Social Interaction**: Preference for screen time over real interactions.

18. **Explain how emotion-focused coping can both promote and hinder psychological adjustment. Support your answer with examples**

Ans: Emotion-focused coping refers to efforts to regulate emotional responses to stress, such as denial, distraction, seeking support, or using substances.

Promoting: emotion focused coping can promote psychological adjustment by reducing anxiety, fear, and emotional distress, thereby helping individuals maintain short-term emotional stability, especially in situations such as illness or medical procedures. Eg: Techniques such as distraction (e.g., engaging in activities or watching television) and cognitive control (focusing on positive aspects of a situation) are commonly used, and for instance, patients awaiting surgery may reduce preoperative anxiety by thinking positively about recovery.

Hindering: emotion-focused coping can also hinder psychological adjustment when it involves avoidance, denial, or suppression of the problem, as these strategies may prevent individuals from taking necessary actions or seeking

appropriate information. For example, patients who refuse to acknowledge their illness or avoid medical information may experience poorer long-term outcomes. (Examples may be different).

19. **Discuss how social support influences physiological health outcomes?**

Ans: Social support refers to the emotional, informational, and tangible assistance individuals receive from their social networks, and it plays a crucial role in influencing physiological health outcomes. In evaluating answers, key points expected include the identification of different types of support—emotional (empathy, care), informational (guidance, advice), and tangible (practical help)—and their role in reducing stress and enhancing well-being.

social support influences physiological health through two major mechanisms: **the buffering** hypothesis, where support protects individuals from the harmful physiological effects of stress by lowering stress perception, and the **direct effects hypothesis**, where social relationships promote better health regardless of stress levels by encouraging positive behaviours and a sense of belonging .

physiological outcomes such as reduced blood pressure, lower cortisol levels, improved immune functioning, and decreased risk of cardiovascular diseases. (Credit should also be given for linking social support with improved mental health, which indirectly enhances physiological functioning. A well-developed response may include examples such as support from family during illness or participation in support groups improving coping and recovery.

20. **Describe Ashtanga Yoga**

Ashtanga Yoga, within the yogic approach to health, refers to the systematic eightfold path aimed at achieving balance across the physical, mental, and spiritual dimensions of human existence. The eight limbs (Ashtanga) include: **Yama (ethical restraints), Niyama (personal discipline), Asana (physical postures), Pranayama (breath regulation), Pratyahara (withdrawal of senses), Dharana (concentration), Dhyana (meditation), and Samadhi (state of self-realisation)**.

21. **Explain different methods used to bring about attitude change in health behaviour.**

Methods used to bring about attitude change in health behaviour include several key approaches that aim to modify individuals' beliefs, motivations, and actions toward healthier lifestyles. Answers should first mention that attitude change is essential for motivating health behaviour change and is achieved through multiple interventions. The most important method is **providing information**, where individuals are educated about health risks, causes, and preventive actions through sources such as mass media, healthcare professionals, and digital platforms . Students should also

include **fear appeals**, which highlight the negative consequences of unhealthy behaviour to create motivation for change, though their effectiveness depends on how individuals perceive the threat. Another important method is **motivational interviewing**, which helps individuals resolve ambivalence and enhances their readiness to change behaviour. Credit should be given for mentioning **behavioural methods**, such as reinforcement, self-management, and incentives, which encourage desirable behaviours through rewards and habit formation. Additionally, **cognitive approaches** like changing irrational beliefs and attitudes through restructuring should be included. Answers may also refer to theoretical bases such as the **health belief model and theory of planned behaviour**, which explain how attitudes, perceived risks, and intentions influence behaviour .